NATYA SHASTRA

Objectives of this session

- To understand the “Rasa Theory” of Natya Shastra
- To understand the concept of “Bhava” & “Rasa”

What is Natya Shastra?

- Source book of Indian Dramaturgy/ Performing Arts
- Book of condensed and codified Rules and regulation of Theatre

Who and When of Natya Shastra?

Was it composed by:

- Bharata Muni in 2nd Century BC?
- Many Scholars during 2nd Century BC?
- Or Many Scholars through Centuries (2nd Century BC – 2nd Century AD)?

Contribution of Natya Shastra to World Dramaturgy

- The concept of Rasa
- "Na hi Rasad rite Kaschid arthah pravartate"

  No meaningful idea is conveyed if the Rasa is not evoked

The Concept of ‘Bhava’

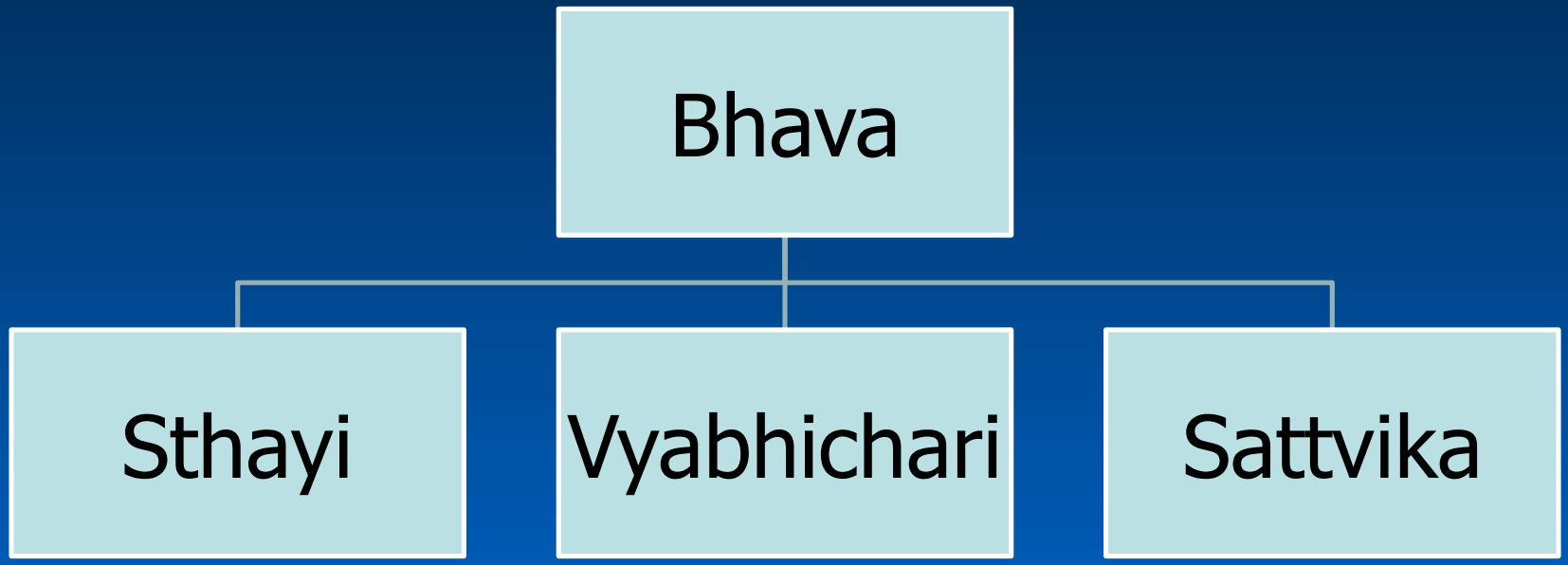
Bhava

"Bhavayati Iti Bhava"

A thing or mental state that brings awareness

- To become
- To come into existence
- To be felt

Classification Of Bhava



This classification is in terms of actual psychological states

Sthayi Bhava

- This literally means abides or remains
- It is a permanent state of the human mind
- These states are linked to desire which are present in every human being
- These mental states are present at sub-conscious level and can be aroused through stimulants
- Only the degree of realization changes
- These can be fully developed and enjoyed

Sthayi Bhava

Bhava
Rati (Love)
Hasa (laughter/amusement)
Krodha (anger)
Utsaha (Dynamic Energy)
Vismay (wonder)
Soka (Sorrow)
Bhaya (Fear)
Jugupsa (disgust)

Vyabhichari Bhava

- These are transitory emotions
- They depend on Sthayi Bhava for strength
- They have no independent existence
- This is also known as sanchari bhava
- They help sthayi bhava to mature into Rasa
- They are 33 in number
- Every individual might not experience all of these during one's lifetime

The Vyabhicari Bhava

Nirveda (world weariness)	Glani (Physical weakness)	Sanka (Anxiety)	Asuya (Envy)	Mada (intoxication)	Srama (Fatigue)
Alasya (Laziness)	Dainya (Depression)	Cinta (worry)	Moha (confusion)	Smrti (Rememberance)	Dhrti (Peace of mind)
Vrida (Shame)	Capalata (Rashness)	Harsa (Joy)	Avega (panic)	Jadata (Lifelessness)	Garva (pride)
Visada (Dejection)	Autsukya (Longing)	Nidra (Sleeping)	Apasmara (Apoplexy)	Supta (Dreaming)	Vibodha (Awakening)
Amarsa (Resentment)	Avahittha (Dissimultion)	Ugrata (Violence)	Mati (Attentiveness)	Vyadhi (Sickness)	Unmada (Insanity)
Marana (Death)	Trasa (fright)	Vitarka (perplexity)			

The Sattvika Bhava

- These are known as involuntary states/Psychosomatic States
- The physical state that is produced due to the unison of mind and body
- The difference between anubhava and sattvika bhava is that the latter is born of sattva

Sattvika Bhava

Stambha (Paralysis)
Sveda (Perspiration)
Romanca (Horripilation/Goose skin)
Swarabhanga (Faltering Voice)
Vepathu (Trembling)
Vaivarnya (Change of color)
Asru (Tears)
Pralaya (Fainting)

Definition

BHAVA

The mental (emotional) states that has the potential of aesthetic experience

RASA

The relishing of the emotional experience

or

The enjoyment or experience created in the minds of sympathetic audience

Understanding ‘Rasa’

Relishing Rasa

- The rasikas enjoy in their heart the durable psychological states when these are represented by an expression of the various psychological states with words, gestures and sattva.

- Thus, as we taste food, we also taste rasa.

- We use taste buds/ tongue to taste food whereas we use heart to taste rasa.

The Rasas

Bharata has mentioned only 8 Rasas:

- Srngara
- Veera
- Karuna
- Hasya
- Roudra
- Vibhatsa
- Bhayanaka
- Adbhuta

The 4 Permanent Rasas

According to Bharata, there is actually 4 permanent Rasas and the other four are outcome from this rasas:

Srngara	Hasya
Roudra	Karuna
Bibhatsa	Bhayanaka
Veera	Adbhuta

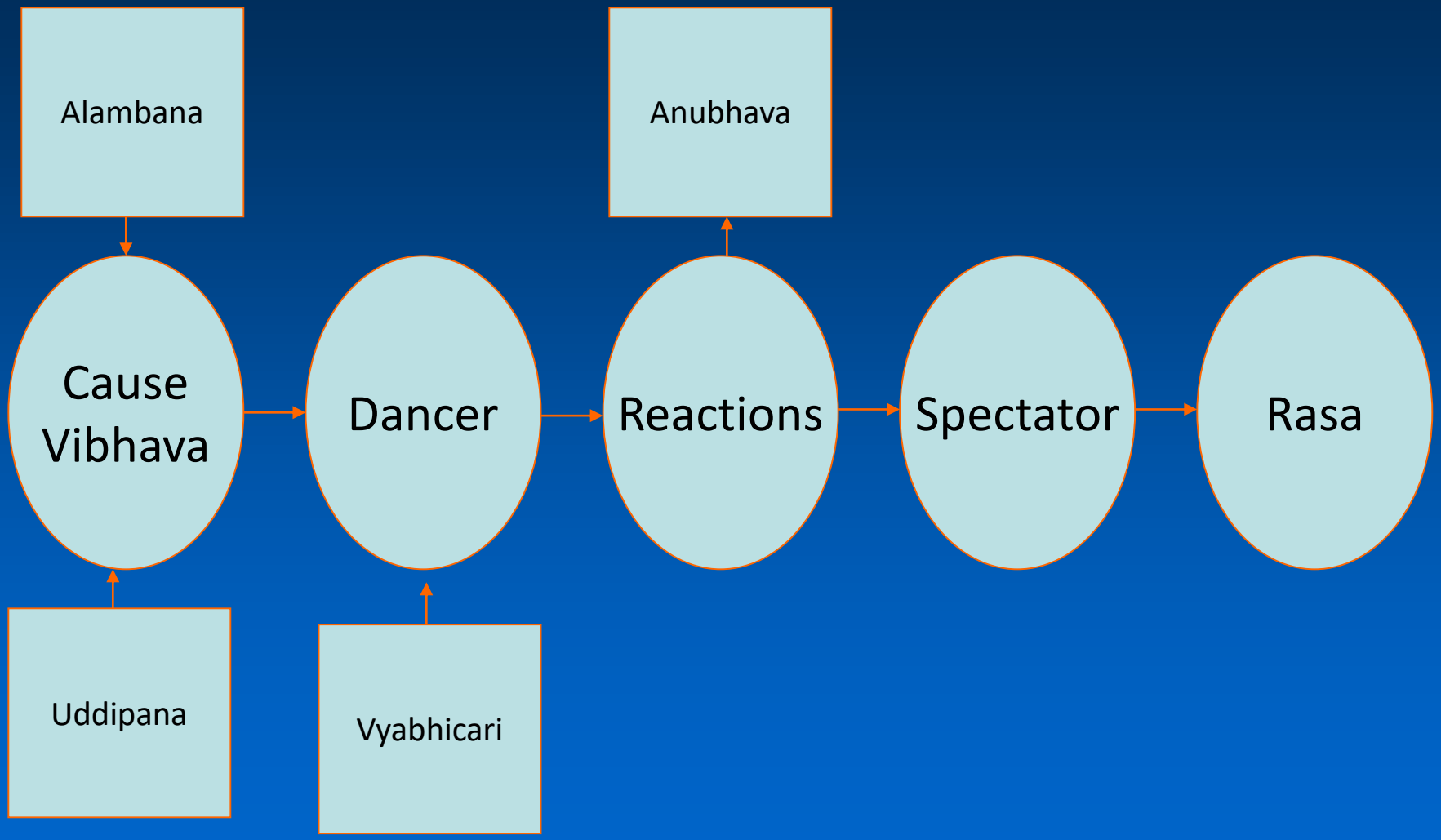
Number of Sthayi Bhava

Bhava	Rasa
Rati (Love)	Srngara (Erotic)
Hasa (laughter/amusement)	Hasya (Comic)
Krodha (krodha)	Roudra (Furious)
Utsaha (Dynamic Energy)	Veera (Heroic)
Vismay (wonder)	Adbhuta (Marvellous)
Soka (Sorrow)	Karuna (Pathetic)
Bhaya (Fear)	Bhayanaka (Terrible)
Jugupsa (disgust)	Bibhatsa (Odious)

Rasa Sutra

Vibhava, Anubhava, Vyabhichari
Samyogad Rasa Nispattih

The Relishing Process in Art Creation



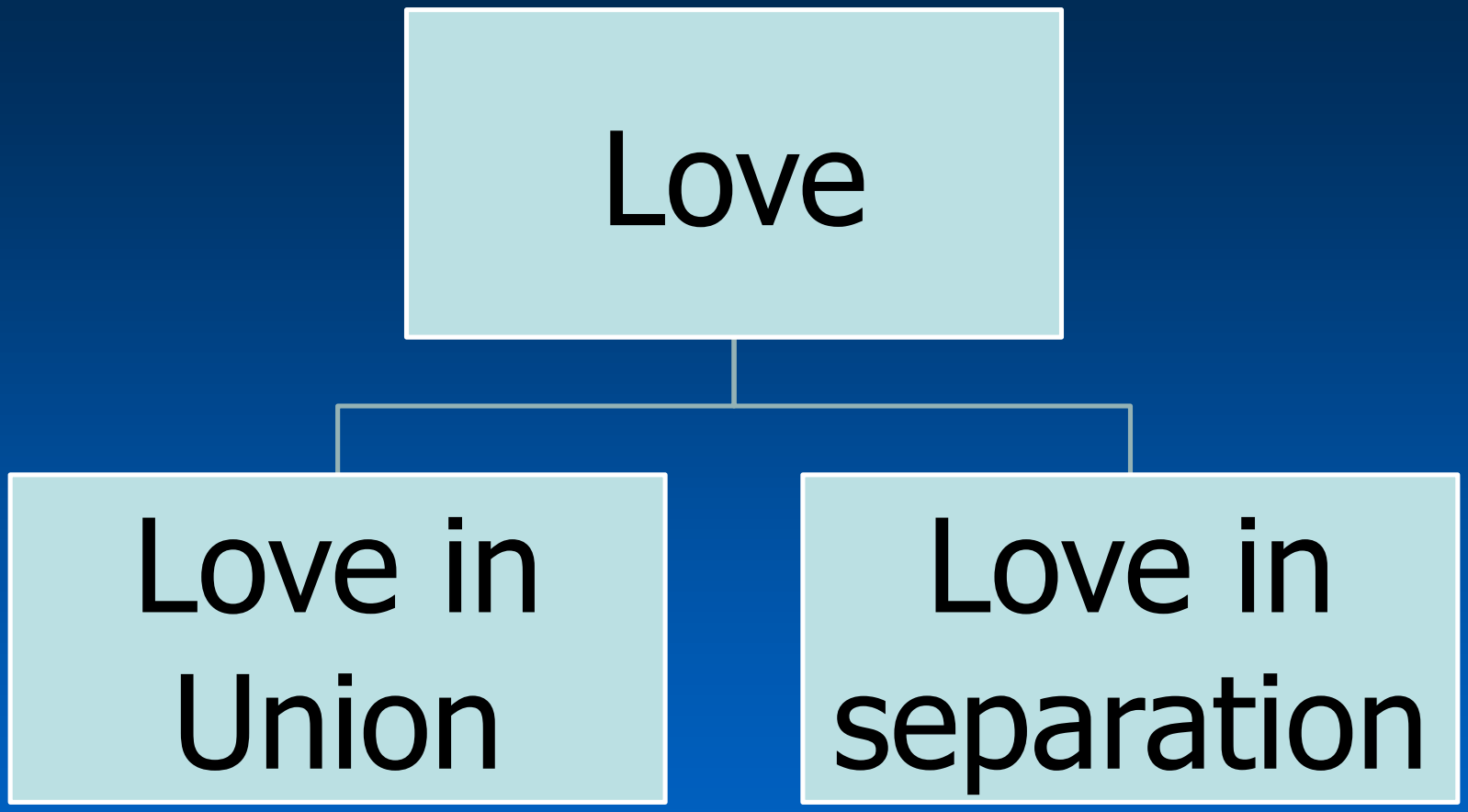
Naba Rasa

Shrngra Rasa

Srngara Rasa

- It arises from the Sthayi Bhava Rati (Love)
- The Lord is Vishnu
- The color is Light Green
- It is associated with pure, bright, shining or beautiful
- The srngara rasa is accompanied by all bhavas

Types of Srngara



Acting it out (Anubhavas for love in union)

- Pleasant face
- Skillful (use) of the eyes
- Side glances
- Frowning
- Flirtatious movements
- Gentle/graceful bodily movements
- Soft Speech
- The following vyabhichari Bhavas do not belong to Srngara: Laziness, Violence, Disgust

Acting it out (Anubhavas for love in separation)

World weariness	Physical weakness
Sickness	Envy
Fatigue	Worry
Longing	Anxiety
Dreaming	Awakening
Insanity	Apoplexy
Lifelessness	Death

Hasya Rasa

- The primary emotion is Hasa (Laughter)
- It arises from vibhava like:
  - Wearing odd clothes and ornaments
  - Shamelessness
  - Tickling sensitive body parts
  - Seeing Comic deformity
  - Describing faults
- The transitory emotions that accompany Hasya are: dissimulation, laziness, drowsiness, sleep, dreaming, awakening, envy etc.

Types of Hasya Rasa

- Subject
  - Self Laughing
  - Making others laugh
- Magnitude
  - Smile
  - Slight Laughter
  - Open Laughter
  - Mocking Laughter
  - Loud Laughter
  - Excessive Laughter

Acting it Out (Characteristic of the noble)

- Smile
  - Cheeks are only little expanded
  - Glance is elegantly suggestive
  - Teeth not visible
  - Smile is restrained

- Slight Laughter
  - Eyes begin to dilate
  - Cheeks puffed out
  - Mouth slightly open
  - Teeth Partially visible

Acting it Out (Characteristic of the common)

- Open Laughter
  - Eyes slightly contracted
  - Cheeks fully distended
  - Sound is soft
  - Face is colored
- Mocking Laughter
  - Nostrils are distended
  - Eyes squint
  - Shoulders bend
  - Head bend

Acting it Out (Characteristic of the low)

- Loud Laughter
  - Laughs out of place
  - Tears in ones eyes
  - Shoulders and head shaking

- Excessive Laughter
  - Eyes are swollen and full of tears
  - Loud and violet cries
  - Holding sides with hands

Karuna Rasa

- The permanent emotion is Sorrow
- The vibhavas that give rise to karuna are:
  - Curse, separation from dear ones, downfall, loss of wealth, death or imprisonment, misfortune, destruction, calamity
- The accompanying transitory states are: world weariness, physical weariness, physical weariness, worry, longing, panic, mental aberration, confusion, fear, dejection, depression, sickness, lifelessness, insanity, apoplexy, fright, laziness, death, paralysis, trembling, change of color, change of voice etc.

Acting it Out (Karuna Rasa)

- Sheding Tears/sobbing
- Drying up of the mouth
- Change of color
- Languour of the limbs
- Loss of memory
- Lamenting/wailing
- Beating / hitting the body

Roudra Rasa

- The permanent emotion is anger
- Characteristic of demons, violent people
- The vibhavas are: anger, provocative actions, insult, lies, assault, harsh words, oppression and envy
- The complimentary states are: correct perception, dynamic energy, panic, resentment, rashness, violence, pride, sweat, trembling, horripilation, shuttering etc.

Acting it Out (Roudra Rasa)

- Red Eyes
- Furrowing of the brows
- Biting one’s lips
- Grinding one’s teeth
- Puffing out the cheeks
- Wringing the hands

Vira Rasa

- Permanent emotion is: Utsaha (dynamic energy)
- The vibhavas are: decisiveness, correct perception, political wisdom, courtesy, bravery, skill in battle, might, eminence etc.
- The transient emotions are: happiness, attentiveness, pride, panic, violence, resentment, remembrance, horripilation

Acting it Out (Vira Rasa)

- Firmness
- Patience
- Heroism
- Generosity
- Pride
- Might
- Profound remarks

Bhayanaka Rasa

- Permanent emotion is: Bhaya (Fear)
- The vibhavas are: ghastly noises, seeing supernatural beings, howling of wild animals, going to a forest, seeing cruelty to one's near and dear ones
- The transient emotions are: Paralysis, sweating, shuttering, horripilation, trembling, break in the voice, change of color, anxiety, confusion, depression, panic, rashness, lifelessness, fright, apoplexy, detach, etc.

Acting it Out (Bhayanaka Rasa)

- Trembling of the hands and feet
- Darting motion of the eyes
- Panic look
- Hair standing on end
- Face color changing
- Drying up of mouth, throat
- Palpitation of the heart
- Horripilation
- Paralysis of the legs

Bibhatsa Rasa

- Permanent emotion is: Jugupsa (disgust)
- The vibhavas are: Seeing ugly, unpleasant, unclean things,
- The transient emotions are: apoplexy, agitation, panic, confusion, sickness, death etc.

Acting it Out (Bibhatsa Rasa)

- Contortions of the mouth and eye
- Holding one’s nose
- Bending one’s head
- Unsure steps
- Spitting
- Vomiting

Adbhuta Rasa

- Permanent emotion is: Ascharya (Wonder)
- The vibhavas are: seeing heavenly beings, gaining one's desired objects, seeing flying chariot, magic show
- The transient emotions are: Paralysis, tears, sweat, shuttering, panic, lifelessness, fainting, seeing unusual work of art

Acting it Out (Adbhuta Rasa)

- Wide eyes
- Staring
- Ecstatic delight
- Waving of hands
- Nodding of heads
- Sweat
- Tears
- Throwing oneself in the air
- Shouting in admiration

The Ninth Rasa

- The ninth Rasa that has been added later on is: Shanta
- The bhava associated with this Rasa is: Nirveda